

T. NAGAR

Saidapet » West Mambalam » Vadapalani » Porur » Kattupakkam » Irungattukottai » Nungambakkam » Manapakkam » Ashok Nagar » Valasaravakkam
Gerugambakkam » Mangadu » Choolaimedu » Egmore » K K Nagar » Kodambakkam » Virugambakkam » Somangalam » Poonamalee » Chetpet

The TASMAL-run liquor shop; and (below) during the meet.
PHOTOS: SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT



Citizens forum seeks removal of liquor shop in West Jhaffer Khanpet

Sapthagiri Colony Residents Welfare Association gives a petition to Virugambakkam MLA

L. KANTHIMATHI

Sapthagiri Colony Residents Welfare Association in West Jhaffer Khanpet has made a representation to the MLA of Virugambakkam constituency R. Sabarinathan seeking removal of TASMAL-run liquor shop (identification number: 664) at Pachaippan Street.

“There are three schools, a temple and a church, all of them located within 500 metres from the liquor shop. So, when the Chief Minister made the announcement of closing liquor shops near educational institutions and places of worship, we expected the one in our area to be closed. As that did not happen, we met the Virugambakkam MLA recently and gave a petition seeking



its removal,” says P. Sudhakar, the association’s secretary. The association also underlines traffic congestion caused by the liquor shop. “Pachaippan Street is narrow but witnesses heavy traffic as it connects West Jhaffer Khanpet and Ramapuram. Those going to

schools in nearby Ashok Nagar and K.K. Nagar also use this road. Traffic crawls during peak hours. And one of the congested spots is near the liquor shop, because customers of the shop park their vehicles and that hinders the traffic flow,” adds Sudhakar.

Disappearing SWD inlets

S.N. RAJARAM

Greater Chennai Corporation relaid the roads at Kaveri Ranganagar in Saligramam a couple of months ago. During the work, the road was laid over those provisions meant for water to flow into stormwater drains. However, corrective measures were carried out at MGR Street alone.

We request Greater Chennai Corporation to address this issue at other roads at the earliest as some of the roads, especially Durai Arasan Street, Kushaldass Street, Indira Gandhi Street, and Navaneethammal Street, are prone to waterlogging.

S.N. Rajaram is a resident of Saligramam



Waterlogging at Pushpa Colony in Saligramam.
FILE PHOTO

Advertisement

ALOPECIA AREATA

Alopecia areata is an autoimmune disorder characterized by sudden patchy hair loss from the scalp, beard, eyebrows, or any other body parts. It is a non-scarring type of alopecia where the hair follicles remain alive, allowing the possibility for regrowth.

PATHOPHYSIOLOGY:

Normally, hair follicles are protected by a mechanism called immune privilege. In alopecia areata this protection is lost and body's immune system mistakenly attacks the growing hair follicles.

DISEASE MECHANISM:

- Autoimmune activation against hair follicles T-lymphocyte mediated inflammation around the hair bulb.
- Premature interruption of an anagen (growth) phase.
- Sudden hair shedding leading to well defined bald patches.

Common associated factors:

Emotional stress, Genetic predisposition, Autoimmune tendency, thyroid dysfunction, atopic background.

HOMOEOPATHIC APPROACH:

Homoeopathy approach alopecia areata through individualized constitutional treatment rather than treating only the local lesion.

PRINCIPLES OF TREATMENT:

- Evaluation of constitutional, person's mental and physical makeup.
- Assessment of mental and emotional state.
- Identification of triggering factors.

- Miasmatic understanding.
- Selection of similimum based totality of symptoms.

Though other physical factors trigger the autoimmune response against hair follicle, homoeopathy focuses on emotional and environment stress. The person's socio, economic situation and interpersonal relationship issue in their living environment triggers the abnormal immune response which destructs the hair roots.

It would heal through changing the abnormal immune response and the hair follicle comeback to normal growth phase.

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VOORA VENTURES



▼ Garbage dumping at Cooum under the bridge on Valluvarkottam High Road in Nungambakkam, near Chetpet.

PHOTOS: LAKSHMY HARIKRISHNAN

switch. An assortment of garbage makes it to this spot, and often the range stretches from household items to those with industrial applications, suggesting dumping by a multiplicity of people, not just residents nearby. Look closer and your eyes will haul in packaging of a diversity of brands, underlining the scale of dumping.

Devi, who lives in a section of Chetpet just 700 metres from this garbage dumping point at Cooum in Nungambakkam and takes the bridge every day on her way to work as a domestic help nearby, makes this observation: “the garbage is primarily dumped by pedestrians taking the bridge at Valluvarkottam High Road; walking through the area has become a challenge due to the mosquito infestation and the foul smell emanating from the accumulated waste.” Sajila .K and Siji .S, two residents of this section of Valluvarkottam High Road echo this sentiment. Greater Chennai Corporation has beautification blueprints drawn up for spaces along Cooum, and can’t the civic body come up with unique plans targeting these vulnerable points?

Putting it in concrete terms, these spaces could be designed in a manner that the design deters garbage dumping; additional checks such as warning boards and even a dummy CCTV camera could be in place.



one needs to inform the local GCC officials who would in turn direct the GCC-appointed conservancy agency to clean the patch. GCC might already be aware of many vulnerable points around Cooum susceptible to garbage dumping, having been informed about it by the Water Resources Department. But it takes persistence from residents to make sure garbage dumping is noticeably checked at these points. Just clearing garbage regularly at these points is not a sustainable solution.

One such vulnerable point is found where the river flows under a bridge at Valluvarkottam High Road in Nungambakkam, not far from Chetpet. Tossing bags of garbage from the walkway on this short bridge is easier than flicking a

A peek into a riverside garbage hotspot

A garbage dumping spot at Cooum near the bridge at Valluvarkottam High Road in Nungambakkam, a stone’s throw from Chetpet, is by no means isolated. It is among points along the river susceptible to garbage dumping; residents can be a pressure group ensuring these spots are redeemed

LAKSHMY HARIKRISHNAN

Crystal-clear waters coursing steadily and reflecting the orange of a setting sun. That is the idle, almost-Pollyannaish hope of this reporter on any twilight hour spent watching the Cooum with its sluggish waters thick as glue and too inky-dark to let the dying sun on the western sky shimmer orangey in those waters. Scrubbing the Cooum squeaky clean and turning that ambitious hope into reality would take the “hyssop” of a massive governmental, inter-departmental, long-drawn effort. As the waterway takes a squiggly course through Chennai,

it is weighed down by sewage and effluents. Freeing the Cooum of those burdens requires multiple interventions.

Now, on its journey, the Cooum carries an additional burden in its backpack: solid waste flung carelessly on its bunds and likely to slip into the waters. Cooum has an expansive underbelly marked with vulnerable points through which garbage sneaks in. A vulnerable point is one where garbage dumping is not only easy, but also seems natural. It supports the thinking: “everyone dumps garbage here; so why can’t I?” But this intervention is thankfully more straightforward. Within Greater Chennai Corporation limits,

Ready targets for litterbugs



Garbage dumping happens in waterways from bridges, sometimes the pile of muck dropped in a landing space below or quietly flung into a patch by the side.

A Water Resources Department official notes that sections of waterways around bridges are often targets of gar-

bage dumping. The bridge increases access and those not living in that neighbourhood could also cart in garbage to have it quietly disposed of.

On Binny Road in Egmore, garbage is regularly dumped by the side of the Cooum, at the end of the pedestrian walkway on the bridge.

Similarly, a patch by the



▼ Littering near the bridge over the Cooum at Binny Road in Egmore; and along the Thiru-Vi-Ka Bridge near Adyar river.

side of Adyar river below Thiru Vi Ka Bridge in Adyar is targeted by litterbugs.

WRD communicates such vulnerable garbage dumping points around waterways to Greater Chennai Corporation; and reportedly, it sends this communication through Chennai Rivers Restoration Trust.



R. RAGU

Four individuals put in a cameo every morning at Harris Road in Egmore as traffic assistants. These are not the government-recognised traffic wardens assisting the traffic police personnel on their beat, just parents seeking to streamline the flow of vehicles dropping off students at St. Anthony's Anglo-Indian High School.

Two of them see those machines through the in-gate and the other two see them off the campus, through the out-gate.

This intervention is hardly recent, having been initiated by a parent 12 years ago. The parent in question Jayaseeman began regulating traffic around the school, as vehicles dropping off students were piling up on the road, partly because they were not allowed inside the campus, the decision shaped by the fact that back then the school had only one gate both for incoming and outgoing vehicles. After Jayaseeman's son completed his schooling, the baton was passed to other parents, and the initiative has been kept humming to this day.

Among those ensuring the exercise's continuity are G. Ravi and A.

Parents in attendance

At this school on Harris Road in Egmore, a group of parents take up the responsibility of regulating traffic during the school-opening hour

Rajkumar, at this voluntary traffic beat for nine and 10 years respectively. Other notable parent volunteers are Rajila and Nagarani. Two years ago, when the management decided to create an additional gate, thereby having separate gates for incoming and outgoing vehicular traffic, these parents' work eased. But then, the rush hour never ceases to be a challenge, throwing a curveball from a quarter least expected.

Regular feedback

For a long time, these parents had been operating with the constraint of regulating vehicles right on the road, as the management was apprehensive about letting vehicles inside. These parents persisted

with the request that vehicles be allowed to roll into the campus. After that request was met, another constraint continued for a long time. The school had just one gate for entry and exit. For these parent volunteers, maintaining two separate lines for incoming and outgoing vehicles took some doing.

With the campus sporting two gates over the last two years, the nature of responsibilities has changed for each volunteer. Ravi is parked right on the road, regulating vehicles of parents and general motorists. Rajkumar is posted at the gates to watch and direct the movement of parents' vehicles. Rajila and Nagarani are at their post inside the campus, ensuring vehicles do not get "entangled" there.



G. Ravi and A. Rajkumar regulate traffic regularly on Harris Road near St Anthony's Anglo Indian High School.

PHOTOS: RAGU R

Ravi points out that while regulating traffic on the road, he has experienced close shaves with vehicles whizzing past, just a hair breadth's distance away, and ac-

rimonious outbursts from motorists that have been stopped for better movement of vehicles in and out of the campus. He shrugs it off as part of the work.

Incomplete cleaning of channel in Koluthuvanchery

R. PALANI

The stretch of a channel carrying surplus water from Chembarambakkam lake to Porur lake on Bharanthiputhur Road at Koluthuvanchery in Iyyappanthangal Village Panchayat was cleaned recently. However, only a small section of the channel was cleaned; the job was hardly tho-

rough-going. Solid waste is found clogging the channel even after the cleaning exercise. The channel, called Thanthi Canal, is crucial in mitigating floods, and its upkeep is important. Several requests to fence the channel to prevent dumping of waste have fallen on deaf ears.

R. Palani is a resident of Iyyappanthangal



The canal. PHOTO: SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

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This beauty queen is a barrier breaker

A hearing-impaired school girl, 16-year-old Saarikha Jagadeesh has been crowned Miss Teen Tamil Nadu 2026. Her answer at the beauty pageant truthfully reflects what she does off stage: using her earnings from her modelling assignments to support children with special needs



▼ Saarikha Jagadeesh being crowned Miss Teen Tamil Nadu by Miss Universe India Manika Vishwakarma at a pageant held on May 29. PHOTOS: SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

tra Hearing Care under whose care she is since the age of two. “To build her confidence, I used to encourage her to look at the mirror and say ‘she looks like a queen,’” says Srividya. That was important because Saarikha did face bullying at school. Under the banner of “Global Raising Challengers Organisation”, Saarikha has given whatever she earned through modelling assignments to support other special needs children. Her first major stage event was at age of 11, where she won the “Junior Miss India” organised by Madarase Universal. There has been no looking back since then. Junior Miss Fab Star, Grand Gala Fashion Week, photo shoots for advertisements and a small role in a film only boosted her confidence.

For the World Fashion Week in Dubai in 2024, she took along three other children with special needs to walk the ramp along with her, training many of them to face the stage confidently.

In 2025, she conducted Tiranga, an inclusive event where 214 children walked the ramp to enter the London Book of Records.

Saarikha admits that making friends was not easy and she took the taunts as a challenge to prove others wrong.

“As a young girl with hearing disability, I know what my parents had to go through to meet my medical expense; the medication that was needed to improve my speech,” says Saarikha. “Modelling gave me confidence. I want other children like me who cannot walk, speak, see and those with Down’s Syndrome to achieve their dreams,” says Saarikha who wants to pursue a career in law.

Srividya remembers the tough search that had to be undertaken to find a swimming coach for her. Finally, an academy took it as a challenge to train Saarikha under water.

The family has a long list of people to thank starting with their former neighbour Kalpana D. Kumar, a speech pathologist. Kalpana nudged them to start early inter-

vention for the little girl.

Behind the young model’s elegant wardrobe is Sasirekha, chief designer at Sasi’s Bangalore Designer, who generously designs her costumes free of charge. A. Saffiberry, founder of Madrase Universal, who saw potential in Saarikha at 11 and continues to mentor her; and Malik, a casting director, who gave her an opportunity to act in *Goat* movie.

Actor Nayana Sai, founder of Southernwoods Model Academy, who has been training Saarikha, says she is a keen observer and a fast learner who can execute things the way you want.

“Even if she is not able to hear certain words, she tries to grasp my lip movement and respond. At times when her hearing aid stopped functioning, she observes and picks up. Pronouncing ‘R’ or ‘S’ word has been difficult but she worked on it,” says Nayana, who has trained more than 150 models.

Agreeing with Nayana, Saffiberry says Silambam moves she performed during the talent round she had learnt in just two weeks time. It gave the audience goosebumps, he says.

Srividya says her husband, Jagadeesh V, was not keen on modelling but never discouraged Saarikha. Jagadeesh ferries her to the many classes she attends.



LIFY THOMAS

Miss Teen Tamil Nadu 2026 Saarikha Jagadeesh’s answer in the question-and-answer round was in earnest, and no empty rhetoric. What she has done in the past points unerringly to that conclusion.

Asked what she would invent to help the world and why, 16-year-old Saarikha replied:

“I would not invent. Instead, I would create opportunities for the underprivileged and the differently abled because I believe that true beauty lies in helping others. Through my initiative, the Global Raising Challengers Organisation I am doing that.”

Saarikha had been diagnosed with bilateral profound hearing

loss as an infant, and the combination early intervention and modern technology has ensured that the world of sound was not shut out for her.

After early intervention at Balavidyalaya, the school for young deaf children in Adyar, till the age of five, Saarikha joined regular schooling starting with St. Francis International School in Kolapakkam followed by Velammal Bodhi Campus in Mugulivakkam. The hearing aid is her constant companion and her lifeline through which she does everything like a normal child. Saarikha is a Class XI student of Ology Tech School in Mugulivakkam.

Saarikha got started on modelling early.

Behind Saarikha’s foray into modelling was her mother Srividya J., and audiologist Dr Rajarajan of As-

23 participants at grand finale



▼ The winners of Miss Universe Tamil Nadu 2026 seen with (second from right) Nandini Nagaraj.

The grand finale of Miss Universe Tamil Nadu 2026 was held on May 29, 2026 at Taj Fisherman’s Cove, bringing together aspiring contestants from across the state in a celebration of beauty, confi-

dence, talent and empowerment.

Twenty-three contestants were in the fray across Miss Universe Tamil Nadu and Miss Teen Tamil Nadu categories.

The panel of judges included

Amjad Khan, director of franchise operations, MUI; Nikhil Anand, national director Miss Universe India; Vaamshi Uday, Miss Universe Karnataka 2025 winner; Kamakshi, Miss Universe Tamil Nadu 2025 winner; and Manika Vishwakarma, Miss Universe India.

According to a release, the winners of Miss Universe Tamil Nadu 2026 are Vaishnavi (winner); Pramiti (first runner-up); and Nikita (second runner-up). Saarikha was declared winner of the Miss Teen Tamil Nadu 2026.

The event showcased not only beauty and fashion but confidence, leadership, and individuality, providing a platform for young women to inspire and make a meaningful impact, said the release.

Nandini Nagaraj, state director for Tamil Nadu and Karnataka, who organised the event, said the success of Miss Universe Tamil Nadu 2026 marks another milestone in empowering women and nurturing future ambassadors who represent grace, intelligence, and purpose.

A green carpet rolled out to nature enthusiasts

Bushwalk corridor, a community-built green space along the Buckingham Canal behind House of Hiranandani Upscale in Egattur on Old Mahabalipuram Road serves as a venue for guided bushwalks and birding sessions, as it did on World Environment Day

SHARON JESSICA MICHAEL

A patch of burnt soil, damaged drip irrigation pipes and blackened tree trunks now mark a section of what is called Bushwalk corridor along Buckingham Canal in Egattur, thanks to a fire that swept through it roughly a fortnight ago. Residents of House of Hiranandani Upscale had ploughed in considerable resources to build this green corridor, located in the space along the Canal, behind the towers. And they would have to allocate more resources to repair and restore the damaged elements. But this setback did not hold The Bushwalk Trust which manages the corridor from going ahead with a public event on World Environment Day (June 5), a walk down the Bushwalk corridor offered to both residents and guests. From time to time, the 'green' carpet is rolled out to nature enthusiasts from anywhere.

Along the way, the corridor had grown massive enough to make administration by a trust necessary. The corridor supports 12,000 plants and serves as a space for guided bushwalks and birding sessions.

The seeds of a green corridor were sown ironically during a "dry" period, the pandemic. Around 3,000 saplings of Arjuna tree had been planted along the Buckingham canal under a Tamil Nadu government urban forestry initiative. "There was no mechan-



ism to ensure their survival," recalls Shanthi Jothilingam, Treasurer of Bushwalk Trust. "Many residents assumed the agency that planted the saplings would continue maintaining them. But when that did not happen, a few volun-

teers stepped in." Among them was R. Shankar, a resident whose commitment would eventually shape the future of the landscape. Having left his job during the pandemic, Shankar found himself spending more time within the community



Images from the World Environment Day walk at Bushwalk corridor; a male Golden oriole photographed at the corridor.

PHOTOS: SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT AND E. ARUN KUMAR

and became increasingly concerned about the fate of the saplings.

"We felt that if we did not act at that stage, thousands of saplings would simply be lost," he recalls. Residents pooled in funds, hired water tankers and spent weekends watering the saplings. The terrain was uneven and covered in dense undergrowth, making access difficult. Volunteers often filled drums with water and carried buckets across the site to reach the plants.

"It was physically demanding work," says Shanthi. "People would come before work, after work or whenever they found time and chip in."

Saplings grew, so did the scope of the initiative. Through Exnora International, the group established ties with Gayatri Trust, which later extended financial sup-

port. Around the same time, Shankar identified an opportunity to utilise groundwater emerging from nearby construction activity instead of allowing it to flow into the Buckingham Canal. The water was tested, found suitable for irrigation and channelled into a pond constructed with external support. From there, a drip irrigation system and sprinklers were installed across the site, dramatically reducing dependence on water tankers and creating a more sustainable maintenance model.

As the project expanded, residents realised the initiative needed a formal structure. The Bushwalk Trust was subsequently established as a legally registered trust, enabling it to receive institutional funding, employ dedicated gardeners and manage its finances transparently.

Children are often at the centre of programmes by The Bushwalk Trust. Plantation drives encourage them to plant saplings and monitor their growth, while nature-based activities foster a deeper connection with the environment.

The corridor has also emerged as an unexpected biodiversity hotspot. E. Arun Kumar, a resident naturalist who has been documenting wildlife in the area since 2021, says the habitat now supports a rich variety of resident and migratory bird species.

"We have documented 176 bird species here," he says. "Every few months, we organise bird walks, particularly during winter when migratory birds arrive. Many children who attend develop a lasting interest in birdwatching and nature."





The violation on P.T. Rajan Salai. FILE PHOTO

'One-way rule violated'

PRANAVI PRASAD

The stretch of P. T. Rajan Salai from Nagathamman Koil junction to the junction of 100-Feet Jawaharlal Nehru Main Road in K.K. Nagar was made one-way a few years ago to

facilitate metro rail construction in the vicinity. However, violation of this rule is a common sight. Further, the footpaths on this stretch are encroached upon for parking of vehicles.

Pranavi Prasad is a resident of K. K. Nagar

Nominations invited for Teachers' Awards

The Shiv Nadar Foundation, in partnership with Said Business School, University of Oxford, has invited entries for the inaugural edition of 'India's Best Teachers' Awards 2026'

The awards are for educators of Geography, Business Studies and Entrepreneurship, Computer Science, Economics, Physics, English, Environmental Sciences, and Mathematics, teaching classes IX to XII.

Applications will be assessed on subject expertise, innovation in teaching methodology, impact on student learning outcomes, and leadership

within schools and communities, stated a release from the foundation.

School principals and heads of government and private schools can submit nominations until July 31 to <https://indiateacherawards.evalato.com/>

Shortlisted finalists will be invited to participate in the final stage of the awards process at Shiv Nadar University, New Delhi - New Capital Region on September 4 and 5.

Award recipients will receive national recognition and a fully funded scholarship to participate in a one-week learning and development programme at Said Business School.

FSCA coaching camp begins in Kodambakkam



Future Stars Cricket Academy recently conducted its Valedictory Prize Distribution function following the successful conduct of its summer camp. T.J. Srinivas Raj, honorary president, TNCA was the chief guest and gave away the prizes.

A total of 85 boys attended the camp through April and May under the guidance of head coach V. Suresh. Talented performers who excelled

in the league tournaments were identified and presented with special awards at the event on May 31, says a press release.

FSCA will conduct its annual cricket coaching camp for players aged between six and 19 from June 6, 2026 to February 28, 2027, on weekends and school term holidays, at Meenakshi College for Women, Kodambakkam.

For details, call 98418 11912, 94449 04745.



Elders care centre launched

Dr. Kamakshi Memorial Hospital has launched Dr. K Elder Care Assisted Living.

Located in the Nanganalur region, the center aims to address the growing need for professional elder care, assisted living, and post-

hospital recovery services.

Dr. V. S. Natarajan, founder of Dr. V. S. Natarajan Geriatric Foundation, acclaimed as 'Father of Geriatrics in India,' inaugurated the center.

According to a press release, the facility offers a

comprehensive range of services, including long-term assisted living, post-hospital recovery care, neuro-rehabilitation, palliative and end-of-life care, and respite care.

The facility is designed to provide a safe, comfortable,

and medically supervised environment for senior citizens and patients requiring rehabilitation and ongoing support, the release added.

The facilities include doctor consultation suites, nursing supervision, physiotherapy services, medication management, wellness programs, and recreational spaces.

Dr. T. G. Sivaranjani, director, Dr. Kamakshi Memorial Hospitals, says, "We have created a nurturing environment where seniors can live with dignity, comfort, safety, and access to professional medical support whenever needed. The vision is to provide families with peace of mind, knowing that their loved ones are receiving compassionate, holistic care in a home-like setting."

Blood donation camp

As part of World Blood Donors Day (June 14), Aalam Group of Chennai Cyclists and Chromepet Cheetahs are organising a blood donation camp on June 14 at two venues.

They are: BBR Community Hall in Chromepet (contact Sankar Sakthivel 91760 30847) and the other at the Institute of Child Health Hospital in Egmore (contact Lokesh 97899 82110).

Course on Montessori teacher training

The Indian Montessori Training Courses (IMTC), Chennai, will commence their 56th Montessori Primary Teacher Training Course later this month.

The course will include online and in-person sessions, a format designed to balance work, family,

and a passion for early childhood education. The course will conclude in March 2027.

The successful candidates will be awarded a diploma by the Indian Montessori Centre, Bengaluru.

As an introduction, IMTC-Chennai is holding

a brief online orientation and walk-in demo sessions for aspiring teachers between June 8 and 12.

For details, WhatsApp and call 94449 36263, 044-24614301. Email: admissions.imtcc@gmail.com

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Petitions presented to Alandur MLA

A time frame for issuing patta, monthly readings for electricity charges and desilting of Adambakkam lake are on the list of demands

T.S. ATUL SWAMINATHAN

The office-bearers of the Federation of Nanganallur (Residents) Welfare Association, led by its advisor V. Rama Rao, submitted a wish list outlining the long-standing demands of the region to the newly elected MLA of the Alandur Assembly constituency, M. Harish.

S. Chandrabose, president, and P. V. Inbasekaran, joint secretary of the federation participated.

V. Rama Rao requested Harish to take up with the Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay the issue of 'patta' without any corruption and delay.

"The State government should fix a time period for issuing 'patta'. If the time period is exceeded after the petitioner has completed the requisite paperwork (reasons for non-issuance), the Tahsildar's office should pay a fine of ₹ 250 per



day, as per the RTI Act rules," said Rama Rao.

Overhead EB cables

The overhead power cables in Nanganallur, Alandur, Pazhavanthan-

gal, and Adambakkam regions should be laid underground, and EB readings should be taken on a monthly basis as in other areas, says S. Chandrabose. There is a need to install a 110 kV substation, but due

to space constraints, it has not been upgraded. The Tamil Nadu Power Distribution Corporation Limited should adopt GIS (Gas Insulated System) Technology. For this, only around 10 grounds are needed. The

The office-bearers of the Federation of Nanganallur (Residents) Welfare Association with Alandur MLA, M. Harish. PHOTO: SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

GIS technology has been implemented in RA Puram, Mylapore and Mandaiveli, said Chandrabose.

Other demands

Desilting and deepening the Adambakkam Lake, constructing ghosals for cattle and revision of property tax are among other demands residents have placed. They have also asked for an auditorium at a park behind Panachi Amman Temple; a road overbridge over Thillai Ganga Nagar subway to help people reach Nanganallur and adjoining areas, as the subway gets flooded, and creation of a traffic junction outside the Meenambakkam subway to help the motorists avoid taking a detour for a U-turn to access GST Road western lane (towards Saint Thomas Mount).

New art gallery in Virugambakkam

An exhibition featuring works of 18 artists is on view till June 10



Artist A V Ilango's work titled

Dancers. Works of 18 well-known and emerging artists are showcased at Art Cube Gallery in Virugambakkam. Titled 'First Impressions' – a celebration of original art, emerging talent, and artistic excellence, this is the debut exhibition at this gallery.

Featuring paintings, sculptures, mixed-media works, photography, serigraphs, folk art, abstracts, limited-edition prints, and collector exclusives, First Impressions offers visitors an encounter with artistic innovation and craftsmanship, said a release.

Another feature of the gallery is its artist-led curation approach. Each exhibition is shaped around carefully selected artists whose originality, dedication, and creative vision have earned recognition through national and international exhibitions and platforms, said the release.

The 18 artists include A. V. Ilango, Asma Menon, Dakshayani B., Dhiyaneshwaran VR, Hemalatha, Jacob Jebaraj, Karthikeyan Pitchaimallian, K.G. Narendrababu, Manisha Raju, N. K. Baskaran, N. S. Manoharan, Raju Durshettiwar, S. Saravanan, Saroja Ravi, Selva Senthil Kumar, Thejomaye Menon and Varalakshmi B.

Beyond exhibitions, Art Cube Gallery would host sip-and-paint experiences, artist residency programmes and art appreciation events.

The exhibition is on till June 10; 10 a.m. to 5 p.m and is free for all. Art Cube Gallery is at Plot 13, 2nd Street, Elango Nagar, Virugambakkam. For details, call Aeishna at 9444118484 / 9360200520

Visit <https://www.artcubegallery.biz/firstimpressions>

Instagram: @artcube.gallery

A new facility



Students at a smart classroom which was inaugurated last week at Government Model Higher Secondary School in Arumbakkam. Minister for School Education, Rajmohan, inaugurated the facility.

On the occasion, he distributed books to the students.

PHOTO : B. JOTHI RAMALINGAM

Exhibition of multilingual picture books

The Library at Goethe-Institut/Max Mueller Bhavan Chennai is conducting an "immersive exploration of big questions in life through children's literature". The event titled 'Litsophical' features a curated exhibition by Rhea Kuthoore and Jigar Bhalani (in picture), facilitators of Philosophy with Children. Participants will also be taken around an exhibition featuring multilingual picture books and thought-provoking questions and activities that engage with the philosophical self.



Litsophical is happening from June 10 to June 20 at Goethe-Institut, Ruthland Gate, 5th Street, Nungambakkam.

For details and to register, WhatsApp 9342267878 or 8816933078 (Rhea)